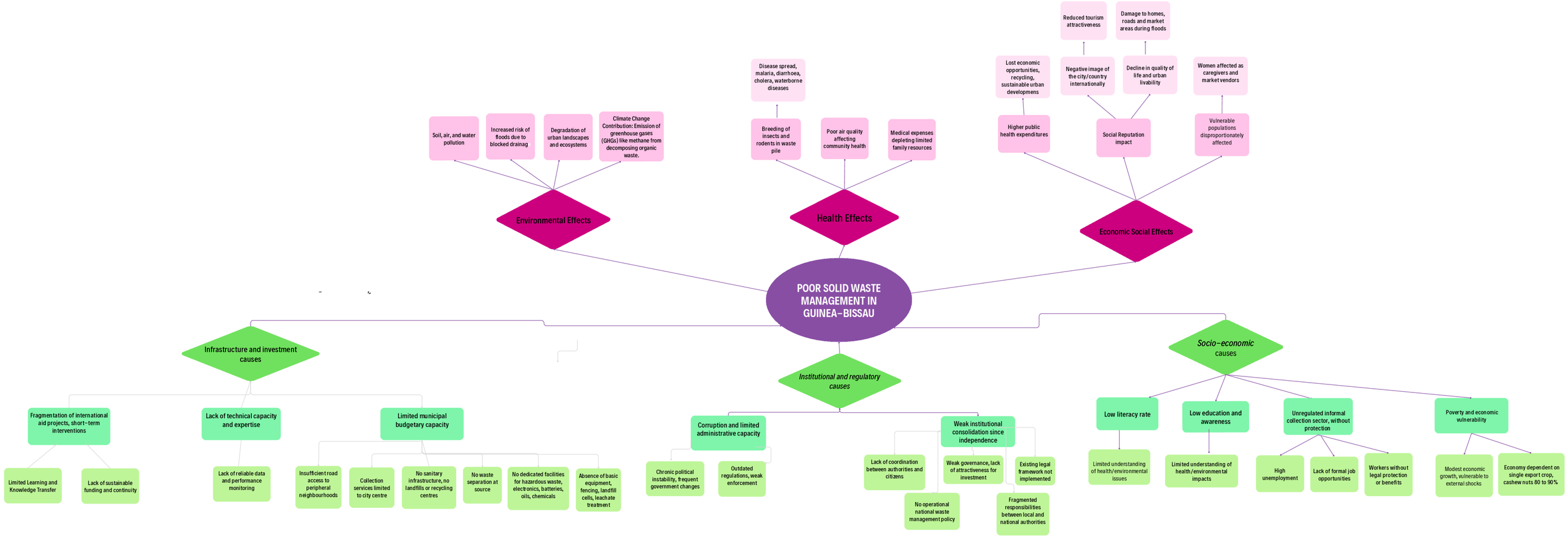
POOR SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT IN GUINEA-BISSAU
Environmental Effects
Soil, air, and water pollution
Increased risk of floods due to blocked drainag
Degradation of urban landscapes and ecosystems
Climate Change Contribution: Emission of greenhouse gases (GHGs) like methane from decomposing organic waste.
Health Effects
Disease spread, malaria, diarrhoea, cholera, waterborne diseases
Breeding of insects and rodents in waste pile
Poor air quality affecting community health
Medical expenses depleting limited family resources
Economic Social Effects
Lost economic opportunities, recycling, sustainable urban developmens
Higher public health expenditures
Reduced tourism attractiveness
Negative image of the city/country internationally
Damage to homes, roads and market areas during floods
Decline in quality of life and urban livability
Social Reputation impact
Women affected as caregivers and market vendors
Vulnerable populations disproportionately affected
Infrastructure and investment causes
Fragmentation of international aid projects, short-term interventions
Limited Learning and Knowledge Transfer
Lack of sustainable funding and continuity
Lack of technical capacity and expertise
Lack of reliable data and performance monitoring
Limited municipal budgetary capacity
Insufficient road access to peripheral neighbourhoods
Collection services limited to city centre
No sanitary infrastructure, no landfills or recycling centres
No waste separation at source
No dedicated facilities for hazardous waste, electronics, batteries, oils, chemicals
Absence of basic equipment, fencing, landfill cells, leachate treatment
Institutional and regulatory causes
Corruption and limited administrative capacity
Chronic political instability, frequent government changes
Outdated regulations, weak enforcement
Weak institutional consolidation since independence
Lack of coordination between authorities and citizens
No operational national waste management policy
Weak governance, lack of attractiveness for investment
Fragmented responsibilities between local and national authorities
Existing legal framework not implemented
Socio-economic causes
Low literacy rate
Limited understanding of health/environmental issues
Low education and awareness
Limited understanding of health/environmental impacts
Unregulated informal collection sector, without protection
High unemployment
Lack of formal job opportunities
Workers without legal protection or benefits
Poverty and economic vulnerability
Modest economic growth, vulnerable to external shocks
Economy dependent on single export crop, cashew nuts 80 to 90%